

disadvantages of this is when I try to make a call using my smartwatch on a crowded bus or metro, where I can't reach my smartphone, I can't get a grip on the call logs.

The experience just worsens, as you can't even access the contacts from your device if you've not added some of the contacts beforehand using the Moto Watch app on your smartphone. That literally leaves you with your memory, as you can only tackle that situation if you remember the phone number of the person you want to connect with or have contacted them using the device before.

HEALTH TRACKING

Motorola's partnership with Polar adds credibility, and features like Smart Calories and Nightly Recharge suggest a data-driven approach.

In regular use, heart rate tracking felt reliable during walks and light workouts. SpO2 and stress tracking delivered consistent readings under normal conditions. One thing to note is that continuous heart rate and SpO2 tracking significantly impact battery life, especially with AOD.

Talking about sleep tracking, while the data presentation is detailed and structured, it still felt less precise to me. The recovery scores didn't always match how I actually felt. In my opinion, there's still room for refinement in interpreting that data.

The watch supports over 100 sports modes, including cricket, which is a



thoughtful inclusion for Indian users. I tested two of the most common features: the indoor and the outdoor walk.

For the indoor step tracking, I felt that the device occasionally registered extra steps during non-walking movements. However, for the outdoor walk, I tested the device for 2 kilometres, which lasted around 21 minutes. The distance and pace tracking were reasonably accurate, the calorie and heart rate readings were close enough for daily tracking.

The main issue I faced was the unexpected auto-pause of the workouts. This wasn't a one- or two-time thing, but something that bugged me several times that I don't even remember the count now. The thing that put me off was that it didn't start automatically and required manual intervention. Whether due to wrist detection or GPS

fluctuation, it happened more often than it should.

Despite dual-frequency GPS (L1 and L5), signal stability under trees and near tall buildings wasn't flawless. It did recover automatically, but hardware advantages didn't always translate into seamless real-world performance, giving me disappointments.

BATTERY LIFE

Under the standard use case, when the Always-On Display is turned off and real-time tracking is disabled, the watch comfortably lasts 12 to 13 days. However, in heavier usage scenarios with AOD and continuous tracking enabled, I

experienced around 4 to 5 days, which is lower.

Charging the watch from zero to full takes about 60 minutes using the two-pin magnetic cradle via USB-C. I didn't experience any noticeable heating during the charging process.

VERDICT

The Moto Watch 2026 feels designed for users who want a lightweight, comfortable smartwatch that handles essentials without constant attention. In normal usage, battery life is strong. Notifications are reliable. Heart rate and SpO2 monitoring work well. Bluetooth calling is good enough for quick conversations.

—Bhaskar Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 1.4" Round OLED | Corning® Gorilla® Glass 3 | Sensor: Dual-frequency GPS: L1/L5 | Compatibility: Android 12 and up | IP Rating: IP68 | Connectivity: Bluetooth 5.3 | Battery: Upto 13 days | Internal memory: 4 GB | Weight: 35g

CONTACT

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